

Chapter 1: Introduction and Vision

The Vasai-Virar City Municipal Corporation (VVMC) introduces this Comprehensive Waste Management Handbook to align our rapidly growing urban region with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), specifically SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities and Communities) and SDG 12 (Responsible Consumption and Production). With a population exceeding 1.2 million across Vasai, Virar, Nalasopara, and surrounding zones, sustainable waste management is our highest priority. The objective of this policy is to achieve a "Zero Waste to Landfill" status by 2027 through mandatory source segregation, aggressive recycling, and strict penalization of illegal dumping.

Chapter 2: Mandatory Source Segregation Guidelines

Under the Solid Waste Management Rules (2016) of the Government of India, all citizens, commercial entities, and institutions within VVMC limits must segregate waste at the source into four distinct categories:

2.1 Wet Waste (Green Bin) - Biodegradable

- **Definition:** Organic matter that breaks down naturally in the environment.
- **Inclusions:** Kitchen waste, fruit and vegetable peels, leftover cooked and uncooked food, eggshells, meat, bones, fish, rotten fruits, tea leaves, coffee grounds, used flowers, and garden waste (leaves, twigs, grass).
- **Processing:** Sent to municipal composting units in Pelhar and Navghar to generate organic manure for city gardens.
- **Handling Rule:** Must be handed over to municipal collectors directly in bins. Plastic bin liners (garbage bags) are strictly prohibited, even if marketed as "biodegradable plastic."

2.2 Dry Waste (Blue Bin) - Recyclables & Non-Biodegradables

- **Definition:** Inorganic materials that can be processed and reused.
- **Inclusions:** Plastic bottles, wrappers, clean milk pouches, cardboard boxes, newspapers, magazines, paper cups, glass bottles, metal cans, aluminum foil, rubber items, and clean cloth/textiles.
- **Handling Rule:** All plastic containers, shampoo bottles, and food delivery boxes must be rinsed with water and dried before disposal. Wet or food-soiled plastic will be rejected by collection staff as it contaminates the recycling stream.

2.3 Domestic Hazardous & Sanitary Waste (Red Bin/Bag)

- **Definition:** Waste containing toxic chemicals or biological contaminants.
- **Inclusions (Sanitary):** Used diapers, sanitary napkins, tampons, bandages, cotton swabs, and syringes.
- **Inclusions (Hazardous):** Expired medicines, broken thermometers, mosquito repellent mats/coils, used batteries, paint cans, chemical cleaners, pesticide cans, and tube lights.

- **Handling Rule:** Sanitary waste must be wrapped securely in newspaper and marked with a highly visible "Red Cross." Hazardous waste must be kept in a separate bag. These are sent for safe, high-temperature biomedical incineration.

Chapter 3: E-Waste Management Protocols

Electronic waste (E-waste) contains harmful heavy metals such as lead, mercury, and lithium, which severely contaminate groundwater if dumped in regular municipal landfills.

- **Inclusions:** Old mobile phones, chargers, tangled wires, cables, broken laptops, earphones, calculators, printed circuit boards (PCBs), televisions, and fused LED bulbs.
- **Disposal Mechanism:** E-waste must NEVER be thrown in daily garbage collection vans. Citizens must dispose of e-waste using one of the following methods:
 1. Drop off at the designated VVCMC E-waste Collection Centers located at the Vasai West Municipal Ward Office or Virar East Zonal Office.
 2. Hand over to the specialized "E-Waste Collection Van" which visits residential societies on the last Sunday of every month.

Chapter 4: Rules for Bulk Waste Generators (BWGs)

A Bulk Waste Generator (BWG) is defined as any residential society, commercial establishment, hotel, hospital, or educational institution that generates more than 100 kilograms of total waste per day.

- **On-Site Composting Requirement:** All BWGs in VVCMC limits are legally mandated to set up on-site decentralized composting units or biomethanation plants for their wet waste. VVCMC collection vans will NOT collect wet waste from BWGs.
- **Dry Waste Tie-ups:** BWGs must sign Memorandums of Understanding (MoUs) with VVCMC-authorized dry waste recyclers or scrap dealers to ensure 100% recycling of their dry waste.

Chapter 5: Construction and Demolition (C&D) Waste

Waste resulting from building construction, renovation, or demolition must be handled separately.

- **Inclusions:** Bricks, concrete rubble, cement blocks, tiles, broken ceramics, and plaster.
- **Disposal Rule:** It is strictly illegal to dump C&D waste on roadsides, in mangroves, or in water bodies. Citizens undergoing home renovations must book a "C&D Waste Pick-up" via the VVCMC Citizen Portal and pay a transport fee of ₹1,200 per metric ton.

Chapter 6: Maharashtra Single-Use Plastic Ban Enforcement

In accordance with the Maharashtra Pollution Control Board (MPCB) directives, VVCMC strictly enforces the ban on single-use plastics.

- **Banned Items:** Plastic carry bags (with or without handles, of any thickness), non-woven polypropylene bags, plastic plates, cups, glasses, cutlery, straws, stirrers, thermocol decorations, and plastic wrapping films around sweet boxes.

- **Exemptions:** Compostable plastic bags approved by the CPCB, plastic packaging for medical equipment, and solid plastic containers used for food packaging (which must be recycled).

Chapter 7: Penalty and Fine Matrix

To ensure strict compliance, the VVCMC Solid Waste Management Flying Squad will conduct random inspections. The following fines will be levied on the spot for violations:

1. **Failure to segregate waste at source (mixing wet and dry):**
 - Individual households: ₹500 for the first offense, ₹1,000 for repeat offenses.
 - Commercial shops/restaurants: ₹2,000.
2. **Littering or dumping waste in public spaces, drains, or mangroves:** ₹5,000.
3. **Failure of Bulk Waste Generators (BWGs) to compost wet waste on-site:** ₹10,000 per month.
4. **Use, sale, or storage of banned single-use plastics:**
 - First offense: ₹5,000.
 - Second offense: ₹10,000.
 - Third offense: ₹25,000 and 3 months imprisonment.
5. **Illegal dumping of Construction & Demolition (C&D) waste:** ₹15,000 plus vehicle seizure.

Chapter 8: Citizen Grievance and Support

Citizens facing issues with irregular garbage collection, or wanting to report illegal dumping, can use the following official VVCMC channels:

- **Toll-Free Helpline:** 1800-233-4353
- **WhatsApp Support:** +91 8888-VVCMC-00
- **Email:** swm.grievance@vvcmc.gov.in
- **Office Address:** Solid Waste Management Department, VVCMC Head Office, Virar East, 401305.